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Space Exploration Technologies Corp. | North America

SpaceX and the Intelligence Economy: $i = er^2$

What is SpaceX’s business model? One could look at it as converting energy (e) into intelligence (i). SpaceX brings vertical integration in AI and manufacturing, leveraging its position in space infrastructure to:

- Minimize \$/kg of launch
- Maximize \$/watt
- Maximize intelligence/watt

See here for our SpaceX Initiation: [SpaceX: AI’s Final Frontier; Initiate at Overweight, PT \\$300 \(7 Jul 2026\)](#)

The story of life = the conversion of ‘e’ to ‘i.’ At the highest level, all biological (organic) and non-biological (inorganic) life is a process of converting energy into intelligence. From the ‘Saganian’ primordial soup of organic molecules in the late Hadean eon (over 4 billion years ago when a cooling of the Earth’s temperature allowed liquid oceans to form) to the drama of human civilization in the Summer of 2026... all life - individually and collectively - is a process of converting the sun’s energy into intelligence.

- A microprocessor converts e to i
- A data center converts e to i
- Your iPhone converts e to i
- A socket wrench converts e to i
- A rocket converts e to i
- The first dividing cell converted e to i
- The discovery of fire was a ‘Promethean leap’ in the conversion of e to i
- The 86bn neurons (and nearly 100tn neural connections) in your brain convert e to i... while running on just 20 watts (an LED light bulb)
- A termite colony converts e to i
- Human civilization converts e to i (not always in a straight line)

What is SpaceX’s role in converting e to i? Fundamentally, SpaceX’s ‘e to i’ journey is no different than any other company. It’s the company’s ‘first principles’ approach, application of [Elon’s Algorithm](#) and DVFS attributes that distinguish the company from its peers. We find it helpful to express this concept in the form of **nested quotients**:

- **Intelligence-per-watt: (i/w).** Measures the energy density of intelligence. Imagine you had 10 companies with the same gross intelligence. All else equal, the one that consumed the least amount of energy would create the

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Space Exploration Technologies Corp. (SPCX.O, SPCX US)

Space Technology | United States of America

Stock Rating	Overweight			
Industry View	Attractive			
Price target	\$300.00			
Shr price, close (Jul 15, 2026)	\$135.27			
52-Week Range	\$225.64-132.15			
Fiscal Year Ending	12/25	12/26e	12/27e	12/28e
EPS (\$) **	(1.69)	0.28	2.18	6.29
Prior EPS (\$) **	-	-	-	-
P/E	NM	477.8	62.0	21.5
EPS (\$) §	-	(0.42)	0.63	3.36
Div yld (%)	-	0.0	0.0	0.0

Unless otherwise noted, all metrics are based on Morgan Stanley ModelWare framework
** = Based on consensus methodology
§ = Consensus data is provided by Refinitiv Estimates
e = Morgan Stanley Research estimates

QUARTERLY EPS (\$)					
Quarter	2025	2026e Prior	2026e Current	2027e Prior	2027e Current
Q1	(0.18)	-	(0.84)a	-	0.54
Q2	(0.34)	-	(0.35)	-	0.55
Q3	(0.36)	-	0.27	-	0.54
Q4	(0.80)	-	0.45	-	0.56

e = Morgan Stanley Research estimates, a = Actual Company reported data

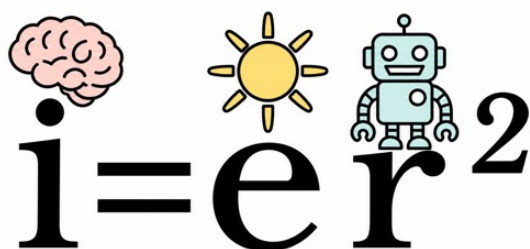
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most value. Can SpaceX achieve higher intelligence per watt vs. its peers? Drivers include access to more efficient chip design, more efficient gateways/routing/software/architecture from DC to the edge. In manufacturing Elon Musk is fond of saying “the best part is no part.” In AI compute, is the best token no token?

- **Intelligence-per-watt-per-dollar: $((i/w)/\$)$.** Measures both the energy density and capital density of intelligence. Imagine you had 6 companies with the identical intelligence-per-watt. All else equal, the one that consumed the least amount of capital to produce their (i/w) would create the most value. Can SpaceX achieve superior capital efficiency vs. its peers? Drivers include design, scale, data, manufacturing and an ability to capture arising data to be fed back into the manufacturing machine in self-reinforcing recursive loops. Data informs the software, which informs the hardware, which informs the manufacturing plant.
- **Intelligence-per-watt-per-dollar-per-second: $((i/w)/\$)/t$.** Measures the energy density, capital density and temporal density of intelligence. Imagine you had 3 companies with identical intelligence-per-watt-per-dollar. All else equal, the one that could deliver their $((i/w)/\$)$ in the least amount of time would create the most value. Can SpaceX achieve superior time to convert ‘e to i’ vs. its peers with the least amount of capital deployed? Drivers include vertical integration, pervasive physical and digital networks. As traditional compute moves towards quantum we see each second of improvement of time to power and ‘time-of-flight’ computing setting some companies apart from others. The most energy efficient intelligence for the lowest price at the right place at the right time - persistently, redundantly, reliably.

Exhibit 1: $i = er^2$



Source: Morgan Stanley Research. Note: i = intelligence, e = energy, r = robots; $i = er^2$ is a conceptual metaphor

Valuation Methodology and Risks

Space Exploration Technologies Corp. (SPCX.O)

Sum-of-the-Parts by Segment: Space, Connectivity, AI (Divided into X & Grok and Enterprise AI)

- \$300 Price Target = sum of Space (\$8), Connectivity (\$128), X & Grok (\$12), Enterprise AI (\$152)

2040 ending forecast period

6/30/2027 valuation date

11.1% WACC; 11.9% Cost of Equity

50% Enterprise AI valuation discount for execution risk

TGR of: 4.0% Space, 4.5% connectivity, 3.0% X & Grok, 5.0% Enterprise AI

Equates to 0.41 EV/EBIT/Growth

Risks to Upside

- Faster Starship reuse progress
- Faster Starlink capacity growth
- Stronger DTC / enterprise adoption
- More neocloud wins
- Cursor ARR acceleration
- Lower AI infrastructure time to power and cost

Risks to Downside

- Slower Starship reuse cadence
- Slower Starlink subscriber growth
- Weaker enterprise AI monetization
- Higher capex / cost per watt of compute
- Longer time-to-power
- Greater funding needs / dilution
- Regulatory delays

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(as of June 30, 2026)

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Coverage Universe			Investment Banking Clients (IBC)			Other Material Investment Services Clients (MISC)	
Stock Rating Category	Count	% of Total	Count	% of Total IBC	% of Rating Category	Count	% of Total Other MISC
Overweight/Buy	1544	42%	453	49%	29%	757	44%
Equal-weight/Hold	1577	43%	390	42%	25%	769	44%
Not-Rated/Hold	3	0%	1	0%	33%	1	0%
Underweight/Sell	544	15%	89	10%	16%	204	12%
Total	3,668		933			1731	

Data include common stock and ADRs currently assigned ratings. Investment Banking Clients are companies from whom Morgan Stanley received investment banking compensation in the last 12 months. Due to rounding off of decimals, the percentages provided in the "% of total" column may not add up to exactly 100 percent.

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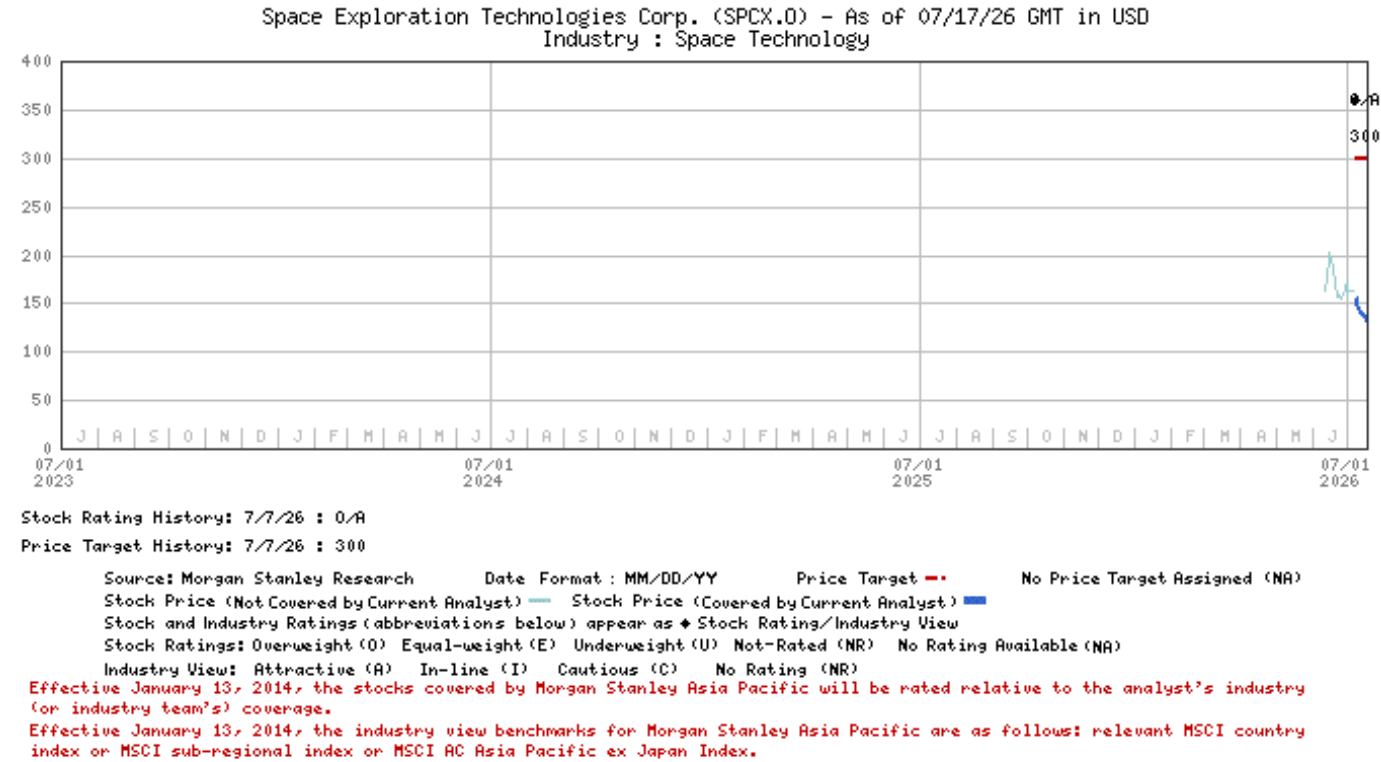
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COMPANY (TICKER)	RATING (AS OF)	PRICE* (07/16/2026)
Adam Jonas, CFA		
Space Exploration Technologies Corp. (SPCX.O)	O (07/07/2026)	\$131.11
Justin M Lang		

Gogo Inc (GOGO.O)	E (08/14/2025)	\$3.55
Iridium Communications Inc (IRDM.O)	E (01/16/2026)	\$46.61
MDA Space Ltd (MDA.TO)	O (01/16/2026)	C\$44.15
Viasat Inc (VSAT.O)	E (12/15/2017)	\$68.71
Kristine T Liwag		
Firefly Aerospace Inc (FLY.O)	E (09/02/2025)	\$19.03
HawkEye 360 Inc (HAWK.N)	O (06/01/2026)	\$18.13
Planet Labs PBC (PL.N)	E (01/22/2023)	\$22.09
Rocket Lab USA Inc (RKL.B.O)	O (01/16/2026)	\$67.35
Virgin Galactic Holdings Inc (SPCE.N)	U (11/22/2023)	\$2.59
Voyager Technologies Inc (VOYG.N)	U (07/15/2026)	\$25.03

Stock Ratings are subject to change. Please see latest research for each company.

* Historical prices are not split adjusted.